

Oral Communication in Context

In day-to-day life a person has to handle a numerous people where he/she needs to cope up with various situations like giving instructions, information, offers, requests, sympathy, condolences, etc. And to deal with those situations a rudimentary skill of communication is required. In English, phrases are being effectively useful to get mastery over the daily conversation. And the sentences with the touch of politeness will add an extra feather into the attainment of consensus being a good speaker. Even the English speakers value politeness over almost everything else. You can speak the most perfect English, but if you appear rude, other people won't want to talk to you. Politeness helps us to deal with other people easily and smoothly. It helps us get on with strangers in a crowded place and it helps us get what we want. So, being polite will help you to achieve your objectives and get what you want. Also, people are more likely to take you seriously and deal with you in a good way. Politeness is such an important part of everyday life and it does not cost anything, so why not try and learn these expressions.

As the 19th century American writer **Joss Billings** said:

Politeness is better than logic. You can often persuade when you cannot convince.

But one problem is that if English isn't your first language, it's difficult to know what's polite and when to use a polite expression. We have been talking about different ways of showing politeness in English, such as through asking different types of questions, using different modal verbs and adding polite words.

There are some important phrases to remember or use in daily conversation.

Asking for and giving information

Phrases for Asking for Information

1. Can you tell me...?
2. Could you tell me...?
3. I'd like to know...
4. Do you know...
5. Do you have any idea...?
6. Could anyone tell me...? (use this phrase when asking a group of people)
7. Would you happen to know...?
8. I don't suppose you (would) know...?
9. I was wondering...
10. I'm calling to find out... (use this phrase on the telephone)
11. Do you happen to know...?
12. Could you find out...?
13. Could you give me some idea of...
14. I'm interested in...
15. I'm looking for...
16. Have you got an idea of....?
17. Don't suppose you (would) know...?
18. I wonder if you could tell me...?
19. I wonder if someone could tell me...?

Examples About Asking for Information:

1. Excuse me, could you tell me how to get to the bus station?
2. Can you show me on the map?
3. Excuse me, do you know where the police station is?
4. How far is it to the beach from here?
5. How are you today?

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6. Where is Jiya?
7. What is in the box?
8. Who is this?

There are some responses, we use:

1. Yes, it is / was / will ...
2. Oh yes, I did / Oh no, I didn't.
3. That's (quite) right.
4. No, it isn't really so.
5. I'm sorry but that isn't correct.
6. Well, it's the contrary in fact.

Dialogue-1

A: Good morning.

B: Good morning. Could you tell me when the movie starts?

A: Let me check....it starts at 7.45.

B: I see....do you know if there is a later showing?

A: Of course I can.....there is one at 9.15, but there is also a late one at 10.45.

B: Thank you. One more thing...could you find out how long the movie is?

A: Let me see.....it says on my paper that it is 2 hours long. But there will be advertisements before it starts. Does that answer your question?

B: Yes it does. Thanks for your help!

A: You're welcome!

Dialogue-2

(Directions to the Museum- *On the street corner*)

Tourist: Excuse me, can you help me? I'm lost!

Person: Certainly, where would you like to go?

Tourist: I'd like to go to the museum, but I can't find it. Is it far?

Person: No, not really. It's about a five-minute walk.

Tourist: Maybe I should call a taxi.

Person: No, It's very easy. Really. (pointing) I can give you directions.

Tourist: Thank you. That's very kind of you.

Person: Not at all. Now, go along this street to the traffic lights. Do you see them?

Tourist: Yes, I can see them.

Person: Right, at the traffic lights, turn left into Queen Mary Ave.

Tourist: Queen Mary Ave.

Person: Right. Go straight. Take the second left and enter Museum Drive.

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Tourist: OK. Queen Mary Ave., straight on and then the third left, Museum Drive.

Person: No, it's the second left.

Tourist: Ah, right. The second street on my left.

Person: Right. Just follow Museum Drive and the museum is at the end of the road.

Tourist: Great. Thanks again for your help.

Person: Not at all.

Offering and Responding to offers

Offer means to give something physical or abstract to someone which can be taken as a gift or a trade.

Offer can be in terms of food, money, solutions, friendship or a bargain.

Offer means to give help. It can be taken or refused.

Offering things

Offering things in English is important for every time we want to be polite, host people at your home or work, etc. We can use the phrases below which is about how to accept offers graciously if we want to treat our guests generously

Here are some of the most important phrases used to offer something:

You can make an offer using a phrase like **Can I...? Shall I...? Would you like me to...?**

For example:

1. **Can I** help you?
2. **Shall I** open the window for you?
3. **Would you like** another coffee?
4. **Would you like me** to answer the phone?
5. Let me help you.
6. Do you need some help?
7. What can I do for you?
8. I'll do it for you.
9. Is there anything I can do?
10. What should I do for you?
11. Would you like any help?
12. I'll do the photocopying, if you like.

- **Shall, can** and **will** are followed by the verb without **to**.
- **Shall** is particularly British English and is more formal than **can**.
- **Would you like...** is followed either by a noun, or by an object pronoun and the verb with **to**.

Responding to offers

These English dialogues show you ways to accept or reject offers made to you.

1. Can I help you?

Yes please. I'd like to know what time the train leaves.

2. Can I help you?

No thanks, I'm just looking. (In a shop)

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3. Shall I open the window for you?

Yes please. **That would be very kind** of you.

4. Would you like another coffee?

No thanks. Or **No thank you.**

5. Would you like another coffee?

Yes please, that would be lovely. Or **Yes please, I'd love one.**

6. Would you like me to answer the phone?

If you wouldn't mind. Or **If you could.**

(Don't answer "Yes, I would", as this sounds like you **expect** someone to do it for you.)

7. I'll do the photocopying, if you like.

It's OK, I can do it. Or **Don't worry, I'll do it.**

Or **Thank you, that would be great.**

Dialogue

(To Offer a Help)

A: Would you like me to help you on your new project?

B: I would love the help! Would you prefer helping with the writing part or is programming more your thing?

A: I would enjoy helping with the writing portion.

B: Perfect! You'll be working alone on that portion. Do you like to work alone?

A: That is OK sometimes.

B: Our first meeting is next Monday. Could you meet with us at that time?

A: No, I can't be there.

B: Please send me your background information before the meeting so I can look at it.

A: I can send that information to you.

B: OK. I look forward to working with you. Enjoy your week!

Requesting and responding to requests

These are the three most common ways for making requests:

1. **Could you** open the door for me, please?
2. **Would you mind** opening the door for me, please?
3. **Can you** open the door for me, please?
4. Can I use your computer, please?
5. Could I borrow some money from you, please?
6. Can/ could you open the window, please?
7. Do you mind if I turn up the heating?
8. Would you mind if I turned up the heating?
9. Do you think you could open the window, please?
10. I'm sorry to trouble you, but...
11. I hope you don't mind my asking, but...
12. I wonder whether you could open the window.

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13. I'd be (very) grateful if you could open the window.
14. Please do me a favour by opening the window.
15. Would it be possible...
16. Would you be so kind as to open the window?
17. Would you mind opening the window, please?

Speaking tips:

- **Could** and **can** are followed by the verb without **to**.
- **Would you mind** is followed by the verb and **-ing**.
- **Could** is more polite than **can**.
- **Do you mind if...** is followed by the verb in the **present tense**, but **would you mind if...** is followed by the verb in the **past tense**.
- When you're using these two sentences, don't use **please**. It's already polite enough!

Dialogue

(Making requests)

Dan: Can I borrow your pen, please?

You: Not now. I'm writing a letter.

Dan: Can I borrow it later, then?

You: Yes, you can borrow it later.

Dan: Can I read your magazine, please?

You: OK. I can't read it now because I'm writing.

Dan: Can I use your phone?

You: No, not now. I'm waiting for a phone call.

Dan: Can I listen to some music on the radio, then?

You: Yes, you can, but play it quietly!

Congratulating people on their success

The gesture of sending a congratulations card says so much all by itself. And often the card's printed message says a lot, too. But you can add warmth and personality with just a few words of your own.

More Casual

1. Congratulations and BRAVO!
2. This calls for celebrating! Congratulations!
3. You did it! So proud of you!
4. I knew it was only a matter of time. Well done!

More Formal

1. Congratulations on your well-deserved success.
2. Heartfelt congratulations to you.
3. Warmest congratulations on your achievement.
4. Congratulations and best wishes for your next adventure!
5. So pleased to see you accomplishing great things.

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Happy for You: “I’m happy for you!” is another warm, enthusiastic message to add in your conversation. It’s hard to go wrong telling someone you’re happy about what they’ve achieved.

More Casual

1. Hope you’re thrilled about your new job! I sure am happy for you!
2. Hooray! We just couldn’t be happier for you!
3. It makes me so happy to think about your promotion. It couldn’t have come to a more deserving person.

More Formal

1. Feeling so much joy for you today. What an impressive achievement!
2. We hope you can feel all the pride and happiness surrounding you as you head off to medical school.
3. Simply overjoyed to hear your good news.

Compliments: A big achievement is a perfect chance to remind someone how talented, hard-working, and deserving they are. (A little achievement is a good excuse, too!)

More Casual

1. You’ve worked so hard for this. Congrats!
2. This is awesome! You’re awesome! Way to go!
3. Congratulations to my favourite new home owner! With your touch, it’s going to look amazing!
4. Bet you thought no one would notice you’ve hit your goal 30 days in a row. Well, I did, and I’m impressed. Here’s to your streak! Keep it up!

More Formal

1. Sincere congratulations on your hard-earned success.
2. You are proof that good things come to those who are willing to sacrifice to reach a worthwhile goal.
3. Words can’t express how proud I am!
4. You have the creativity and determination to do whatever you can dream. I hope you feel proud today and confident in your ability to rise to your next challenge.
5. Celebrating the dedication you’ve shown on the way to this achievement. You’ve earned every bit of the success you’re enjoying.

Looking Ahead

A friend’s or loved one’s success provides an opportunity, not only to celebrate the moment, but also to encourage them and look forward to future successes.

More Casual

1. I’ve got a feeling this is only the beginning of even more great things to come for you!
2. Celebrating the record you just set and looking forward to watching you cross your next finish line!
3. Congratulations on your new place! Can’t wait to see you make it your own.

More Formal

1. I’m sure today will be only the first of many proud moments for you at your new firm.
2. Sending you heartfelt congratulations today and wishing you all the best on your next project.”
3. I commend you on this latest success, and I look forward to seeing even more great things from you.

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Writing Tip: Face-to-face praise tends to embarrass some people, but a written message removes some of that immediacy. That's the beauty of a card. So go ahead and gush a little in what you write!

Dialogue (Congratulations for Exam)

Jiya: You look happy today!

Chirag: I'm happy. I have just passed my Literature exam and my History exam.

Jiya: Congratulations! I'm glad somebody's happy.

Chirag: Why? What's the matter?

Jiya: Oh, I'm just worried I guess. I have to take a History exam next week.

Chirag: Oh, come, you are always worried about your exams. You've passed some exams already, haven't you?

Jiya: Yes, I've passed my French exam.

Chirag: Oh, I give up. I simply can't learn French.

Jiya: Why do you say that? I think you're making a lot of progress.

Chirag: No, I'm not. I try and try and I still can't speak it very well.

Jiya: Learning any language takes a lot of effort. But don't give up. One can scarcely get on without some knowledge of a foreign language. Why don't we practice those dialogues together?

Chirag: Good idea. That just might help.

Expressing sympathy

1. How sad! Poor you.
2. I'm awfully/ dreadfully sorry.
3. O dear! I am sorry. I'm awfully sorry.
4. What a pity! That's awful.
5. That's too bad.
6. That's so sad.
7. I'm sorry. What bad luck!
8. I hope things get better soon.
9. It would be OK soon.
10. I hope you feel better soon.
11. Oh, that's terrible.
12. Be patient, it would be better soon.
13. I can't tell you how sorry I am.
14. Oh, I am sorry to hear that.
15. I know how it feels.
16. I take my sympathy to you.
17. You must be very upset about it.
18. I sympathize with your condition.

Responding:

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1. It's very kind of you.
2. Thank you very much.
3. It would be Ok, thanks.
4. Thanks for your sympathy.
5. Thanks for your support.

Dialogue (At the School)

Mr. Ankit: Good morning, teacher.

Mr. Gaurav: Good morning, Mr. Anton. Anita has been absent for the last two days. Is she unwell?

Mr. Ankit: She had an accident.

Mr. Gaurav: Oh, no! I hope it's nothing serious.

Mr. Ankit: It is bad. She was hit by a scooter while crossing the road. Her right leg is fractured.

Mr. Gaurav: How unfortunate! Is she in a hospital?

Mr. Ankit: No, she's at home. But she has to remain in bed for a month. So I came to give her leave application.

Mr. Gaurav: you must be really upset about it. Please don't worry about the classes. Anita is a very bright girl. She can easily make up for the classes she misses. She'll be all right very soon. Please give her my love.

Mr. Ankit: I'll do that. Thank you, teacher.

Expressing condolences

Dealing with emotions is hard for everyone. There are many occasions when condolences are needed due to a death. There are also several ways of expressing condolence. You can send flowers, a gift, or a sympathy card. You can also donate money to a charity they supported, write in a condolences book, take food to the family of the deceased, or offer to help them in some other way.

The word "condolence" comes from the Latin "**condolere**" meaning "**to suffer together**." Sometimes the dictionary lists the word "pity" as a synonym, but "comfort," "commiseration," "sympathy," and "consolation" are better synonyms. It really means acknowledging a loss, showing sympathy, and empathizing with someone.

1. Please accept my condolences.
2. We are sorry for your loss.
3. I was saddened to hear that your grandfather passed away. My thoughts are with you and your family.
4. With heartfelt sympathy...
5. It's terrible to hear about your loss and I express my sincere sympathy to you and your family.
6. I am deeply saddened by the loss that you and your family have encountered. My condolences.
7. May my condolences bring you comfort and may my prayers ease the pain of this loss.
8. I can't imagine what you must be feeling right now, but I want you to know that we are just a phone call away. My heartfelt condolences.
9. I hope that our Lord brings you and your family the much-needed peace during this sad time. My condolences.
10. Prayers and fond memories are what we have to remember our dearly departed. My most heartfelt condolences.

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11. A prayer, a flower, a candle and sad tears of pain on your grave, our dear grandfather
12. I am truly sorry for your loss. Your uncle will be missed and he will never be forgotten, may his soul rest in peace.
13. May God put her in a special place where she will be watching us, the people who loved and cherished her!
14. May God forgive and accept her soul into the Garden of Eden, near the throne of whom she seeks and loved!
15. Condolences to the bereaved family. My tears are flowing for a friend, a great girl. God rest her soul in peace!
16. Despite the loss of the physical presence of your father. We know that God has assigned him to watch over you throughout your life.
17. In this sorrowful time, we would like to extend to you our heartfelt condolences. May our Lord comfort you and your loved ones.

Dialogue

(A Conversation about condolences of friend mother's death)

Waqas: Ali we are grieved to learn of your mother's death.

Zahid: She was an angel of a mother.

Waqas: But now take heart. We share your grief. Let's pray that her soul may rest in eternal peace.

Zahid: Karim, you feel at times that God is cruel and even unjust. But if you think calmly you will see a bright light shining out of darkness.

Waqas: Yes every cloud has a silver lining.

Zahid: When winter comes can spring be far behind?

Waqas: Suffering is like fire. Fire doesn't burn gold. It only purifies gold. Adversity refines your character as fire refines gold.

Zahid: You can't have a heavy rain if a cloud isn't thick and dark.

Waqas: The darker the cloud, the heavier the rain.

Expressing regret

1. I wish I hadn't missed the Train.
2. I feel I shouldn't have been so rude to the students. I'm so sorry if I've hurt you.
3. I'm sad to hear that.
4. I'm sorry I couldn't come.
5. I regret missing the chance.
6. Isn't it a pity we missed that film!
7. If only I hadn't failed the test!
8. If only I had listened to them!
9. That's a great pity.
10. That's a pity.
11. It's a pity you couldn't come.
12. It's quite unfortunate.
13. Really, we should have invited them
14. Why did I ever say that?
15. I think it was mean of us not to help them out.
16. Nobody regrets this more than I do.

Apologizing and forgiving

The Art of Apologizing

“You must first apologize before you can have a chance at being forgiven.” The right apology will release resentment and cause all people involved to feel better. Apologizing is so important because without it, the person offended will not forget it and the resentment will continue to nag the relationship.

When apologizing it is important to validate the other person’s feelings. If they are upset by something you did or said or what ever, do not tell them THEY are overreacting. We all have a right to our feelings and by apologizing properly you are validating theirs. Say something like: “I’m sorry for yelling at you, you have a right to be upset”.

You should also say what you are sorry for, while validating their feelings: “I’m sorry for not calling when I knew I was going to be late, that was very inconsiderate of me” or “I’m sorry for getting mad at you, I was being overactive” or “I’m sorry for the things I said earlier, it was very mean of me”. When I hear “I’m sorry” with no explanation of why, I think: ‘And what are you sorry for? Do you even know? Or do you think those two words fix everything?’ By clearly admitting your mistake and not making excuses for yourself you are telling the other person that you sincerely do feel bad, and that is what they want to hear.

Example. I apologize for... [ex. the delay] **(Formal)**

1. I’m sorry that... [ex. I was so rude yesterday]
2. It’s my fault. (= I am taking responsibility for the problem)
3. Oops, sorry. (for very small problems)
4. I should have... [ex. called you and told you I’d be late]
5. I’m terribly sorry. I’m awfully sorry.
6. I’m very sorry that this has happened. I didn’t mean it.
7. I’m sorry you’ve had to wait so long.
8. I’m sorry – I really am.
9. I’m sorry if I worried you.
10. I’m sorry, we’ve really let you down, and there’s no excuse.
11. I’m really sorry about it.
12. I’m sorry I’m a little late for my appointment.
13. I’m sorry for not calling when I knew I was going to be late, that was very inconsiderate of me.
14. I’m sorry for getting mad at you, I was being over reactive.
15. I’m sorry for the things I said earlier.
16. Sorry, I’m not ready yet.
17. Look, I really must apologize for what I’ve done.
18. Sorry, I haven’t finished it yet.
19. Sorry about that. I hope you don’t mind.
20. I hope I’m not disturbing you.
21. Sorry, this is all entirely my own fault.
22. How stupid of me! I wasn’t thing.
23. Sorry, I can’t find it anywhere.
24. Please forgive me for all this confusion.
25. I do beg your pardon.
26. I’d like to apologize for all that.
27. I can’t begin to say how sorry I’m about it.
28. Please excuse me for it.

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29. I'm so very sorry for saying all that.
30. Oh, you must forgive me. I had no idea.
31. I have to leave early.
32. I hope you'll excuse me.
33. Look, I didn't mean to upset you.

Phrases to Respond to an apology

1. That's OK.
2. It happens.
3. No problem.
4. Don't worry about it.
5. I forgive you. (for serious problems)
6. It's OK.
7. Forget it.
8. That's all right.
9. It's all right. It doesn't matter this time, but don't repeat it.
10. Not at all.
11. Please don't worry.
12. I don't want you to feel bad about it.
13. That's perfectly all right.
14. Don't worry about it.
15. Anyone can make a mistake.
16. Oh well, I suppose it's all right.

Accepting Apology or Forgiving:

1. It's OK, but don't do it again, will you?
2. All is forgiven.
3. It's quite all right.
4. I do wish you'll be more careful. Don't worry about it.
5. It's all right
6. Well, all right.
7. That's all right.
8. Everybody makes mistakes sometimes.
9. It doesn't matter at all.
10. Never mind.
11. Don't apologize.
12. Don't worry about it.
13. Don't mention it.
14. That's OK.
15. I quite understand.
16. You couldn't help it.
17. Forget about it.
18. No harm done.

Dialogue

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First person: I'm dreadfully sorry, but I've broken a plate.

Second person: Oh, that doesn't matter.

First person: I'm ever so sorry. Tell me where you bought it so I can get you another.

Second person: No, certainly not. I wouldn't dream of letting you do that.

Giving instructions

- We use the imperative form to give orders or directions in English.
 1. Eat your vegetables!
 2. Turn left and go straight on.
- We can also use the imperative form to give a warning or advice, and (if you use "please") to make a request.
 1. Practise English for ten minutes a day!
 2. Be careful!
 3. Please take a seat.
- To make the imperative, use the infinitive of the verb without 'to':
 1. Come here!
 2. Sit down!
- To make a negative imperative, put "do not" or "don't" before the verb. (Don't is more informal than "do not".)
 1. Don't go!
 2. Do not walk on the grass.

Dialogue

(At the Bank)

Bank Clerk: Good morning, welcome to the Grammar Bank. How can I help you?

Customer: Good morning. I would like to open a bank account.

Bank Clerk: Sure thing. What kind of account would you like to open? A savings account or a checking account?

Customer: What's the difference?

Bank Clerk: A checking account is designed to use for everyday transactions. Yet; the money in a savings account is meant to stay in the account and earn interest over time.

Customer: I see, actually I want to apply for a credit card. That's why I need an account.

Bank Clerk: Okay then, you probably want a checking account.

Customer: Well, thank you. I'd like that.

Bank Clerk: Sure, we will have you fill out an application form, please.

Customer: No problem.

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Bank Clerk: How much of a credit limit were you looking for?

Customer: I would like a \$10,000 spending limit.

Bank Clerk: Alright, we will see what we can do. We might be able to get you one of our gold cards with a \$10,000 spending limit.

Customer: Wonderful. Will I also collect points when I use the card?

Bank Clerk: Sure, with our gold card you will get 10 reward points for every dollar spent.

Customer: Perfect, I have filled out the form. Do you need anything else?

Bank Clerk: You just need to deposit a minimum of \$250 into your new checking account.

Customer: Very well, here you are.

Bank Clerk: Thank you, your account is set up now and your credit card will be mailed to your address within 5 to 10 business days.

Customer: Thank you for your help, have a good day.

Bank Clerk: Thank you, you too.

Seeking and giving permission

When you ask for permission to use something that belongs to someone else you have to do your best to be polite. It is desirable to use the word "please."

Asking for permission:

1. Can I use your pen, please?
2. Can I sit here?
3. Can I go out, please?
4. Can I ask you a question?
5. Can I take a look at your book?
6. May I use your computer?
7. May I open the window, please?
8. May I come in?
9. Please, can I have a look at your photo album?
10. Please, may I taste that hot spicy couscous dish?
11. Is it okay if I sit here?
12. Do you mind if I smoke?
13. Do you mind if I turn down the TV?
14. Do you mind if I use your phone?
15. Would you mind if I opened the window?
16. If you don't mind, I'd like to smoke.
17. I wonder if I could borrow your car for a few days.
18. Would you mind if I asked you something?
19. Would it be all right if I borrowed your phone?

Giving permission:

1. Sure.
2. Sure, go ahead.
3. No problem.
4. Yes, you can.
5. Please feel free.

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6. I don't mind.

Dialogue

(Asking for Permission which is given)

Student: Would it be possible for me to have a few more minutes to review before the quiz?

Teacher: Please feel free to study for a few more minutes.

Student: Thank you very much.

Teacher: No problem. Do you have any questions in particular?

Student: Uh, no. I just need to review things quickly.

Teacher: OK. We'll begin in five minutes.

Student: Thank you.

Dialogue-2

(Asking for Permission which is denied)

In this example, an employee is asking for time away from work.

Employee: Would you mind if I came in late to work tomorrow?

Boss: I'm afraid I'd prefer if you didn't.

Employee: Hmmm. What if I work overtime tonight?

Boss: Well, I really need you for the meeting tomorrow. Is there any way you can do whatever it is you need to do later?

Employee: If you put it that way, I'm sure I can figure something out.

Boss: Thanks, I appreciate it.

Expressing opinions (likes and dislikes)

Saying your likes:

1. I adore

Example: I adore Madonna's music.

2. I like

Example: I like chicken kebabs

3. I love

Example: I love your drawing.

4. I am keen on

Example: I am keen on martial arts.

5. I am crazy/mad about

Example: I am crazy about you.

6. I prefer

Example: I prefer romantic movies.

Saying your dislike:

1. I dislike

Example: I dislike rock music.

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2. I don't like

Example: I don't like curries.

3. I can't stand

Example: I can't stand air fresheners.

4. I abhor

Example: I abhor drugs.

5. I detest

Example: I detest terrorists.

6. I loathe

Example: I loathe onions.

7. I hate

Example: I hate bikes.

Dialogue

(You have made a new friend Simon and he visits your home one day)

You: So Simon, which is your favourite sport?

Simon: I love football. What about you?

You: I adore football and watch every match.

Simon: Great! Let's watch a movie? Which type will you prefer?

You: I am mad about action movies but love the horror ones.

I will bring something to eat. What do you want?

Simon: I am keen on spicy food but detest chips.

You: I, on the other hand, love chips.

Agreeing and disagreeing

Agreeing:

1. I tend to agree with you.

2. That's a good idea.

3. I'm with you on that point.

4. I'll go along with that.

5. Absolutely! I agree with your point.

6. I totally agree with that idea/proposal.

7. I hold exactly the same view.

8. I couldn't agree more.

9. That's absolutely true.

10. That's just what I was thinking.

11. That's exactly my position.

12. That's how I see it too / how I feel too.

Disagreeing:

1. I see things differently.

2. I tend to disagree with that idea.

3. I agree up to a point. However, ...

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4. You have a point there, but ...
5. Sorry, but I think you've missed the point.
6. You could be right. However, ...
7. The idea is worth considering, but ...
8. Perhaps a weakness of this is that ...
9. Well, I'm not sure of that because ...
10. That might be acceptable if ...
11. I'm afraid I don't agree / I disagree.
12. I strongly / totally disapprove of the plan.
13. I'm absolutely against the proposal.

Dialogue

(You have discussion with a friend about banning smoking)

A: Hi _____ .

B: Hi _____ . What's happening?

A: Nothing much. I'm just watching a debate on TV. It's about banning smoking in public buildings.

B: Oh, yeah. I heard that that was going to be on. So, what do you think about it?

A: Well, I don't think people should be allowed to smoke in public places, so I support the ban.

B: Really? I'm surprised. I'm a smoker, so I should have the right to smoke whenever I want.

A: But don't you think that non-smokers have rights, too?

B: Sure. You don't have to smoke if you don't want to. What's the problem?

A: Well, I think that I should have the right not to breathe smoke.

B: So why can't you just go outside if it bothers you?

A: I could ask you the same question. Why can't smokers just go outside if they want to smoke?

B: Well, smoking is part of my lifestyle. I can think better if I have a cigarette.

A: I can breathe better if I don't have to breathe smoke. Smoking is bad for your health. Doctors say that even breathing second-hand smoke can cause cancer.

B: Well, I'm a smoker, and my health is good.

A: Yes, but will it be good in fifteen years?

B: I hope so.

A: I hope so, too. Listen, I think we'll just have to agree to disagree about this subject. Do you want to watch the debate with me?

B: Sure.